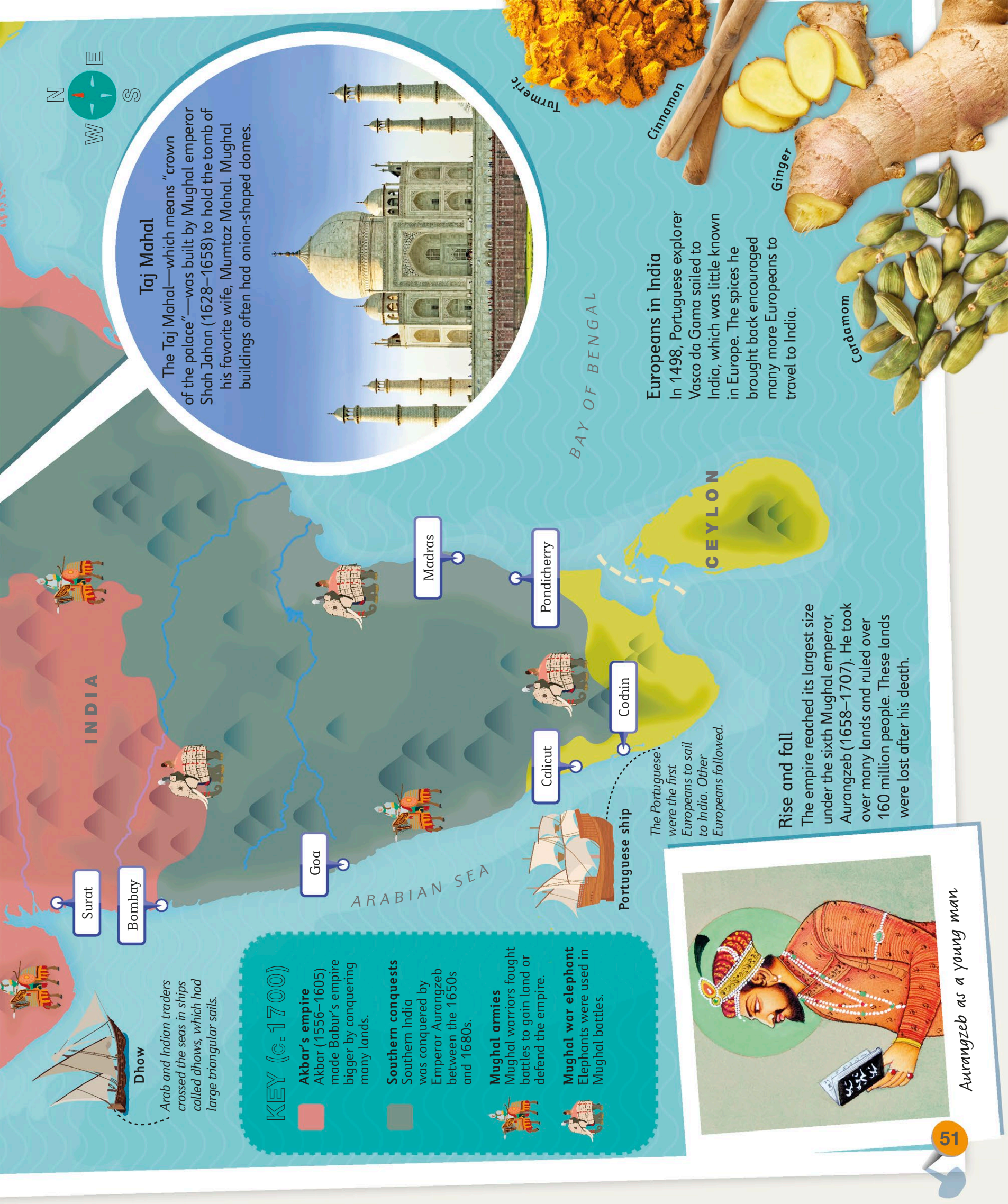


Taj Mahal

The Taj Mahal—which means “crown of the palace”—was built by Mughal emperor Shah Jahan (1628–1658) to hold the tomb of his favorite wife, Mumtaz Mahal. Mughal buildings often had onion-shaped domes.



BAY OF BENGAL

Europeans in India

In 1498, Portuguese explorer Vasco da Gama sailed to India, which was little known in Europe. The spices he brought back encouraged many more Europeans to travel to India.



Rise and fall

The empire reached its largest size under the sixth Mughal emperor, Aurangzeb (1658–1707). He took over many lands and ruled over 160 million people. These lands were lost after his death.



Aurangzeb as a young man

KEY (c.1700)



Akbar's empire
Akbar (1556–1605) made Babur's empire bigger by conquering many lands.



Southern conquests
Southern India was conquered by Emperor Aurangzeb between the 1650s and 1680s.



Mughal armies
Mughal warriors fought battles to gain land or defend the empire.



Mughal war elephant
Elephants were used in Mughal battles.

Portuguese ship

The Portuguese were the first Europeans to sail to India. Other Europeans followed.



Calicut

Cochin

Pondicherry

Madras

Goa

Surat

Bombay

Arab and Indian traders crossed the seas in ships called dhows, which had large triangular sails.

Dhow

